

To the layman, what this translates to, of course, is better phones at lower prices. In fact, with respect to some of the devices we've tested this month, calling them *cell phones* is tantamount to an insult. They represent the new era of smart and truly connected devices.

Although we'd initially meant to test mostly PDAs and smartphones, we haven't forgotten our promise in May of covering a few of the mainstream models as well. You'll find a smattering of them in our entry-level category. We did a lot of market research and dug out some of the hottest handsets around for this comprehensive shootout. We've also split up the test into two very distinct categories—business-oriented devices (including PDA phones) and multimedia-oriented devices, to enable quick buying decisions!

BUSINESS PHONES

Fondly called *smart smartphones*, PDA phones are the Einsteins of the handset world. In general, a PDA phone will have better hardware under its hood, and will be capable of running a greater variety of applications than will a regular smart-

phone. A faster processor and more memory equate to greater productivity, and a PDA phone will also offer additional connectivity and productivity options.

Earlier the cherished darlings of the rich, PDA phones have now become sufficiently inexpensive to be sought after by lesser mortals like executives and managers, who can utilise their many functions in a productive way. In fact, a PDA phone is also very much within reach of your average urban college-going spoilt brat (with a little money management).

Most PDA phones offer users the ability to work seamlessly with documents and spreadsheets, and will provide the flexibility of a full QWERTY keypad while providing wireless connectivity and e-mail client support, should you need to mail your labours to your boss in office while on a tour. A PDA phone is also a fraction of the size and weight of a laptop.

